Stephen Fleming bats for two hours and 40 minutes. He is a seasoned competitor, a great captain. I know that I need to keep going and not allow him anything. At 102/3, I win the battle, forcing him to go at one outside off stump he doesn't need to, fencing it to Kevin Pietersen at backward point. Then, the big one – Ross Taylor. He's playing brilliantly – very well judged and watchful – and has 53. I decide to bang one in slightly shorter, see if the pitch will help me. It does, moving a fraction off the pitch, away from Taylor, who cannot adjust his stroke in time and edges behind to Tim Ambrose. I look up at my figures on the big screen. They read 16.2–4–41–5. Suddenly, there is no pain, no past, no surreal sense of not being sure where it came from. I feel more like this is what I will be able to do now, some sort of element of control suddenly within my grasp.

As we walk off, the Test won and a series deficit overturned, for the first time I don't feel like I am celebrating as a tiny island – a personal milestone reached and a mysterious place inside an intimidating world more real. Next to Broad and the rest of the team, an evolving unit of players, a kind of togetherness becomes us as we leave. We are imagining a future where individuals might not be in competition with each other, but a more sort of harmonious tension might be created. It's not going to be pretty, I am reminded by my ankle as the agony returns in the absence of the adrenaline. There is always going to be pain and uncertainty, but at least from here, we are going to try and do things our way. I don't think either Stuart or I would have believed that would mean returning to the Basin Reserve 15 years later to pick up our thousandth collective wicket for England. Ten of them came this week.

It is the crowning moment of Peter Moores' reign as England coach so far too, to have shown such faith in both of us. He is very good at identifying players who might be on the outside and trusting them, making them great. I feel lucky to be in the slipstream of his guidance at this time and finding myself at exactly the right time of my career to have a coach with the bravery to make choices like that. He is kind too – to a fault and with everyone he meets. His batting coach, Andy Flower, is really helping me with my batting. His direction is clear and specific, and under him I become the team nightwatchman, channelling this newfound, desperate determination for the team into 20s and 30s, to pitch in where I can. It's six years in, but I feel like only now I'm really ready to start.